

CASE CLASSIFICATION SHEET IN PHARMACOVIGILANCE

Purpose: A case classification sheet helps a PV professional consistently classify an Individual Case Safety Report (ICSR) before processing, medical review, and reporting.

1. BASIC CASE IDENTIFICATION

Field	What to record
Case ID / Safety Report ID	Unique identifier assigned to the case.
Initial / Follow-up	Identify whether this is a new report or follow-up information.
Country	Country where the event occurred / report originated.
Date received	Date the company/organization first received the information.
Source	Consumer, healthcare professional, literature, regulatory authority, patient support program, etc.

2. VALID CASE CHECK

Before detailed classification, check the four minimum elements of a valid ICSR:

Element	Question	Example
Identifiable patient	Can a patient be distinguished?	Age/sex or patient identifier available.
Identifiable reporter	Can the reporter be identified or contacted?	Doctor, pharmacist, patient, etc.
Suspect product	Is a medicinal product identifiable?	Drug name / active ingredient.
Adverse event/reaction	Is an event/reaction described?	Rash, nausea, hospitalization, etc.

3. CORE CASE CLASSIFICATION

Classification	How to classify
Serious / Non-serious	Assess seriousness criteria: death, life-threatening condition, hospitalization/prolongation, disability/incapacity, congenital anomaly/birth defect, or other medically important condition.
Expected / Unexpected	Compare the reaction with the applicable reference safety information (e.g., local label/CCDS/Company Core Safety Information as appropriate).
Listed / Unlisted	Use the relevant reference document and company/regulatory rules. Do not assume that absence from one source automatically determines regulatory reporting status.
Valid / Invalid	If one of the four minimum ICSR elements is missing, follow the applicable procedure for invalid/incomplete reports and attempt follow-up when required.

Important: Case classification must follow the organization's current SOPs, applicable product information, and regulatory requirements. When uncertain, escalate for appropriate medical/regulatory review.

CASE CLASSIFICATION WORKSHEET — PRACTICAL FORMAT

Use this page as a working template when reviewing an ICSR. Enter only information supported by the source report; do not infer missing clinical facts.

4. CLASSIFICATION WORKSHEET

Case field	Entry / classification
Case ID	_____
Report type	☐ Initial ☐ Follow-up ☐ Duplicate suspected
Source	☐ HCP ☐ Consumer/patient ☐ Literature ☐ Authority ☐ Other
Patient	Age: _____ Sex: _____ Identifier available: ☐ Yes ☐ No
Suspect product	Product: _____ Active ingredient: _____
Event/reaction	_____
Seriousness	☐ Serious ☐ Non-serious Criterion: ☐ Death ☐ Life-threatening ☐ Hospitalization ☐ Disability ☐ Congenital anomaly ☐ Other medically important
Expectedness / listedness	☐ Expected/listed ☐ Unexpected/unlisted ☐ Needs reference check
Causality	Reporter assessment: _____ Company/medical assessment: _____
Outcome	☐ Recovered ☐ Recovering ☐ Not recovered ☐ Fatal ☐ Unknown ☐ Other
Duplicate check	☐ Not suspected ☐ Possible duplicate ☐ Confirmed duplicate
Reportability	☐ Reportable ☐ Non-reportable ☐ Requires regulatory/medical review

5. SIMPLE PV CLASSIFICATION FLOW

Receive report → Check minimum ICSR elements → Search for duplicates → Identify suspect product & event → Assess seriousness → Assess expectedness/listedness → Assess causality → Determine reportability/timelines → Quality check & submit/escalate according to SOP.

6. MINI EXAMPLE

Information received	A patient reports a rash after starting Drug X. A healthcare professional provides the report and the patient can be identified. No hospitalization or other serious criterion is reported.
Classification	Valid ICSR: identifiable patient + identifiable reporter + suspect product + adverse event. Seriousness: non-serious based on the information provided. Expectedness/listedness: check the applicable reference safety information. Causality: document the reporter/company assessment according to SOP.
Next step	Check duplicates, enter structured data, code the reaction using the organization's approved terminology, perform quality review, and assess reporting requirements/timelines.

7. QUICK CHECKLIST FOR A PV TRAINEE

☐ Four minimum ICSR elements checked ☐ Duplicate search completed ☐ Seriousness assessed ☐ Reference safety information checked
☐ Causality documented ☐ Outcome recorded ☐ Reportability/timeline assessed ☐ QA/medical review completed where required

Training note: This is an educational template, not a substitute for a company's SOP or applicable regulatory guidance. Classification terms and reporting rules can vary by jurisdiction, product, and procedure.